

WEEK 3 - LAB SESSION TASK

7th of Oct and 14th of Oct

Everyone in each pair individually reads around the topic and makes decent notes outlining arguments in favour of their “assigned opinion”. Each pair has to present a balanced 5 mins presentation and a slide deck (please send slides to TAs in advance). Students will be also required to prepare questions for their course mates in other teams, so please look through the topic list and brainstorm possible follow up questions!

The presentations should contain: 1) arguments for 2) arguments against 3) how did you change your minds over the course of the exercise? 4) where do your opinions differ and why? 5) can you reach a common conclusion?

During the 7th of Oct session, you will be assigned to a topic, a position (for/against) and a pair.

Topic list:

1. Ransom payments should be made illegal.
2. Users should be paid for their personal data.
3. Social media accounts should be private by default, even if it reduces engagement and discovery.
4. No one should be anonymous online
5. Every machine should come with a virtual private network (VPN) by default
6. Digital consent is meaningless
7. Governments should license private companies to hack back against cybercriminals.
8. Inclusive security is too expensive for companies to implement.

9. Secure “development” or “programming” should be taught at first year.
10. Phone manufacturers should be legally liable for making stolen phones easy to resell.
11. We need backdoors in our encryption systems.
12. “Anonymous” hacker group are heroes.
13. AI models that can find software vulnerabilities should be available to everyone, not just vetted defenders.
14. Phishing simulations that deceive employees are unethical.
15. Protecting your smartphone is your personal responsibility
16. Developers should be legally liable for vulnerabilities in their products.

17. Facial recognition technology should be banned in public spaces.
18. Cybercrime victims should be compensated by the hacked organisations
19. There’s no point in keeping your social media presence private
20. Hacker representations in Hollywood did more harm than good to the security community
21. Security education should replace part of the existing curriculum in schools.
22. Platform or service owners should compensate users when there is a hack or data breach
23. People who hack without permission in good faith should be rewarded rather than prosecuted.

24. AI should be allowed to take defensive actions without human approval.
25. Accessibility and inclusive security should be legal requirements, not voluntary best practice.
26. Countries should be allowed to hack each other.
27. Privacy is dead.
28. Security awareness training doesn't meaningfully change behavior.
29. Security updates should be mandatory and not optional.
30. Security nudges are manipulative.